

7 October 2026

Editor-in-Chief
BMC Bioinformatics

Dear Editor,

Re: Major revision of “UsherPipe: a genome-wide multi-evidence pipeline for prioritizing candidate genes in Usher syndrome and related ciliopathies”

Thank you for the opportunity to revise our manuscript. We have addressed both reports in the accompanying point-by-point response and revised the manuscript and Supplementary Methods.

The revision distinguishes seed-free raw scoring from the control-calibrated HIGH priority tier and reports final control retention and filtering losses. It adds matched disease comparators, simple weighting baselines, shortlist-membership and missingness diagnostics, and analyses of the cerebellar expression proxy. We have retained the biological rationale while clarifying the score’s limited disease specificity and the absence of production hair-cell measurements.

We also completed a retrospective temporal evaluation of two historical analogues. The AI-assisted literature-screened cohort is provisional pending individual human clinical/date verification. Forty-one of its 45 later target-association genes were in the historical protein-coding universe; neither analogue recovered a principal case in the top 100 or HIGH tier. Top-100 nonrecovery is reported in the Abstract; the main Results also show the empty or near-empty genome-wide historical HIGH tiers. Source substitutions, post-cutoff method development and non-exhaustive clinical ascertainment limit interpretation. The revised claim is transparent hypothesis organization, without demonstrated reliable novel disease-gene prediction. Production weights, scores and thresholds were not optimized against these outcomes.

The revised submission includes editable documents, figures, additional files, derived replay inputs and temporal protocols/results. Checksums identify the actual delivered artifacts. The original production run and submitted materials are preserved. Code and analysis records are available at <https://github.com/gbanyan/usher-exploring/tree/major-revision-author-review-20261007>; the completed numerical-analysis checkpoint is 736e16f, and the package manifest records the revised source and artifact hashes.

Thank you for considering the revised manuscript.

Yours sincerely,

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The exact author-review release is identified by the fixed Git tag major-revision-author-review-20 261 007 and the delivered-file SHA-256 manifest.